MalikTrades

CHART SETUP

Volume profile · VWAP · ATR

PART 01

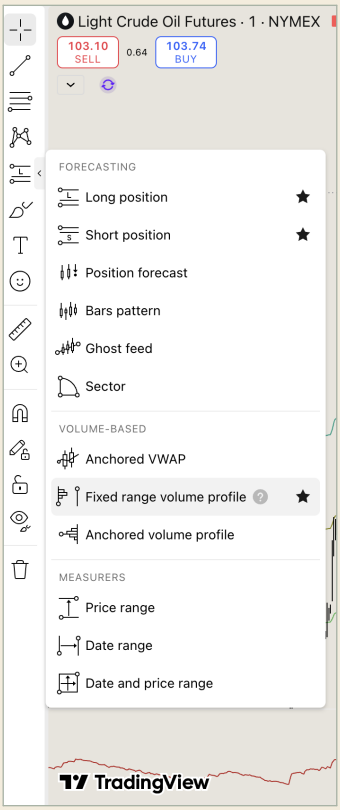
The Volume Profile

Fixed range volume profile — the tool everything else hangs off.

1.1

Find the tool

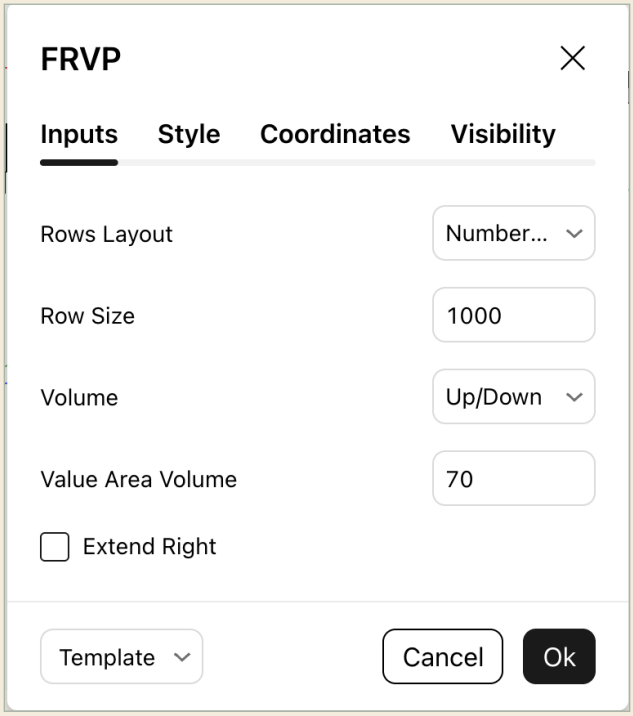
On the drawing toolbar down the left of the chart, click the icon above the paintbrush. Under **VOLUME-BASED**, choose **Fixed range volume profile**. Hit the star next to it so it sits in your favourites — you'll be drawing this on every session.



1.2

Set the inputs

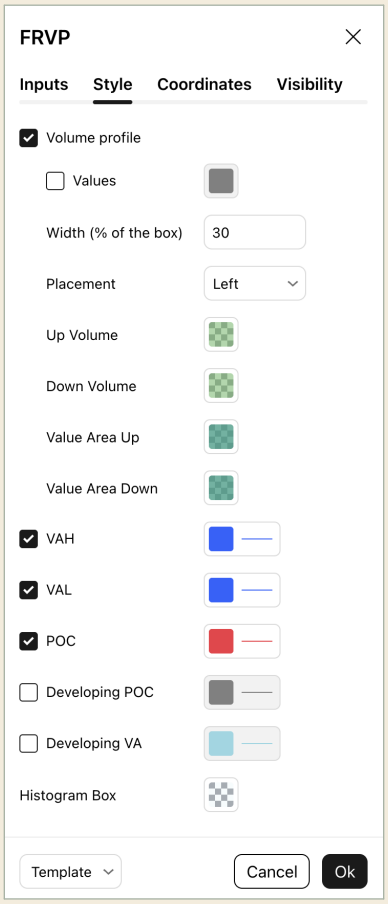
Right-click the profile once it's drawn and open Settings. **Row Size 1000** gives you enough resolution to actually see the shelves rather than a blurry blob. **Volume: Up/Down** splits buying and selling. **Value Area Volume 70** is the standard 70% of trade, which is what makes the VAH and VAL mean anything. Leave **Extend Right** unchecked so the profile stays on its own range instead of projecting across the chart. **The one exception is the developing profile** — on that one you tick Extend Right, so the developing levels carry across to where price is trading now.



1.3

Set the style

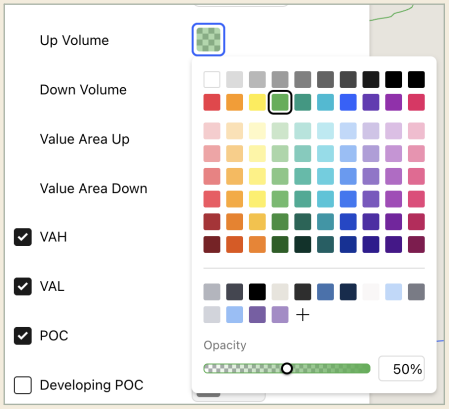
Width 30 and **Placement Left** keeps the histogram out of the way of price. **Values off** — the numbers are clutter. Turn **VAH** and **VAL** on in blue and **POC** on in red, so the three lines you actually trade are instantly separable. Leave **Developing POC** and **Developing VA** off here; this profile is for pre-existing levels, not the developing one.

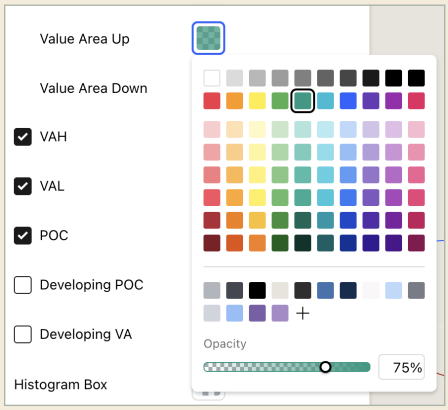


1.4

Colour the volume

Click the **Up Volume** and **Down Volume** swatches and set both to the same green at **50% opacity**. Then set **Value Area Up** and **Value Area Down** to teal at **75%**. Same colour for up and down is deliberate — I'm reading *where* volume built, not who built it — and the darker value area makes the 70% block jump out of the rest of the profile.

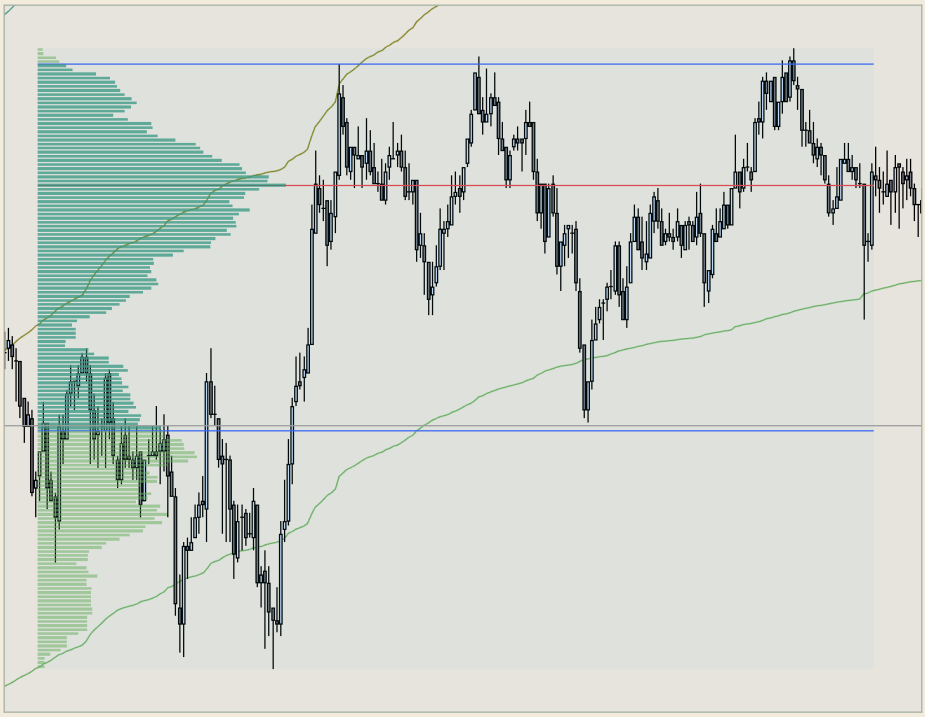




1.5

What you should end up with

A profile sitting on the left of its range, a red POC, two blue value area lines, and a darker block showing where the bulk of the business got done. If you can see the shelves at a glance without squinting, it's set up right.



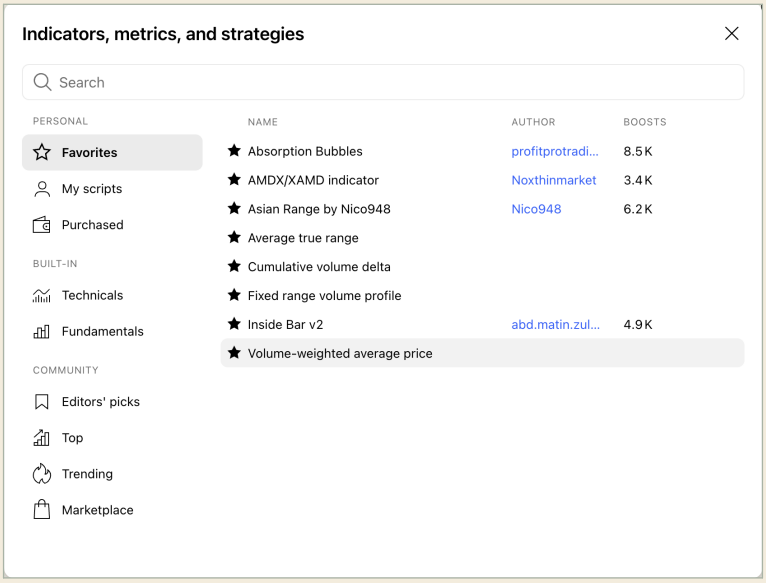
PART 02

VWAP

Session fair value, with three bands of stretch.

2.1 Add the indicator

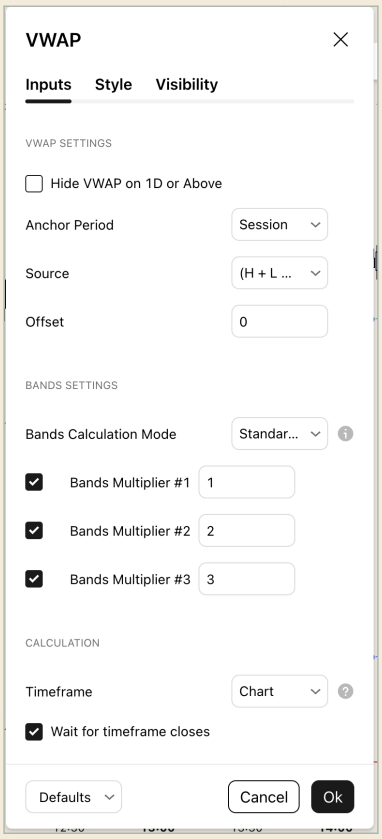
Open **Indicators** at the top of the chart and search for **Volume-weighted average price**. Star it while you're there.



2.2

Set the inputs

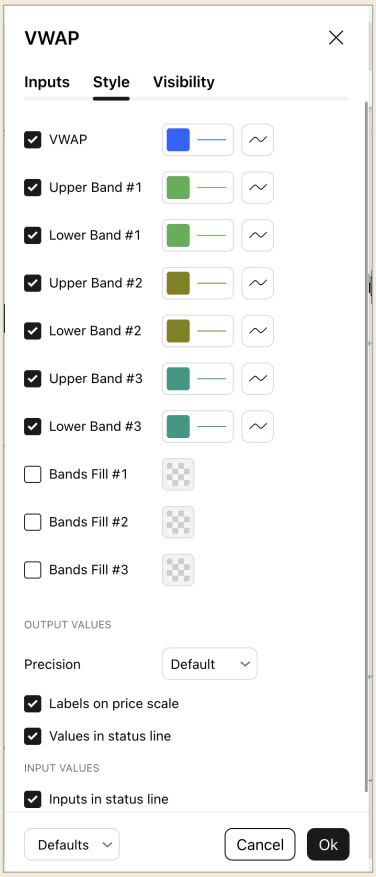
Anchor Period: Session so it resets every session and only ever shows you this session's fair value. **Source: (H + L + C) / 3** — the typical price, so each bar contributes the middle of its range rather than just its close. **Bands Calculation Mode: Standard Deviation**, with multipliers **1, 2 and 3**, so band width scales with the session's own volatility instead of a fixed distance. **Wait for timeframe closes** on, so nothing repaints while a bar is forming.



2.3

Set the style

Turn on **VWAP** and all three **Upper / Lower Band** pairs, with a different colour per band so you can tell at a glance how stretched price is. Leave all three **Bands Fill** boxes off — the shading buries the profile underneath.



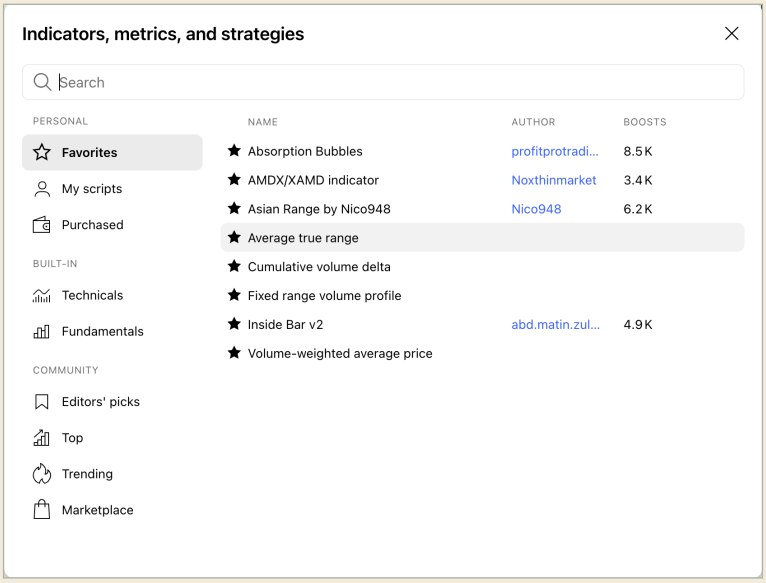
PART 03

ATR

One number, used for stop size.

3.1 Add the indicator

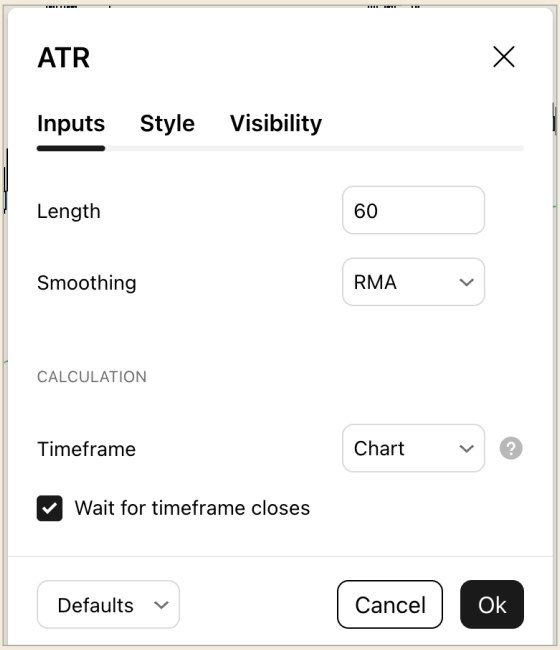
Indicators → Average true range.



3.2

Set the inputs

Length 60 with **RMA** smoothing. A 60-period average on your execution chart is slow enough that the number doesn't jump around between trades, which matters because the stop rule depends on it. **Wait for timeframe closes** on, same reason as VWAP.



3.3

Set the style and use it

One line, in a colour you can read off the bottom panel at a glance. The reason it's on the chart at all: **stop loss at ATR × 2**, which gives the trade enough room to breathe without guessing at stop size.

